

## Call him . . . perfect

New Bedford’s hunky new Melville statue is already turning heads

*In our weekly series, One Special Thing, the Globe arts staff highlights something timeless — movies, books, TV shows, albums, paintings, plays, symphonies, dishes — that we return to in good times and bad. Something we’re just dying to tell you about. The only parameter is passion.*

By Meredith Goldstein  
GLOBE STAFF

The announcement sat in my inbox like many local press releases do, the subject line fairly standard.

“Statue Dedication Anchors New Bedford Whaling Museum’s Melville in Our Seaport Weekend Aug. 13-16.”

I scrolled through the email with mild curiosity, mostly because I’m interested in statues. They’re often up forever, and when they’re ugly,

it’s unfortunate.

I scanned the message for a picture . . . and then I saw it.

“Oh,” I thought.

What a handsome statue. What a handsome man.

To be crystal clear: the new 7.5-foot Melville statue — which will be unveiled outside the chapel near the museum known as Seamen’s Bethel during a series of celebratory events this week-end — is hot.

The bronze work — depicting an ageless Melville with a wind-swept beard, standing in the hard ribs of a whale — is rugged. Maybe he possesses the spirit of the man Melville could have been if he’d known “Moby-Dick” would become one of the

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STEFANIE ROCKNAK

The wind-swept beard adds a certain rugged quality, wouldn’t you say?

## Lawsuit against Harvard dismissed

Trump administration rebuffed on claims of school antisemitism

By Michaela Towfighi, Camilo Fonseca, and Brooke Hauser  
GLOBE STAFF

One of the more explosive lines of attack President Trump launched against Harvard University hit a dead end on Thursday when a federal judge in Boston dismissed the administration’s lawsuit that alleged the university violated civil rights law in its treatment of Jewish students.

The dismissal offers a reprieve for Harvard, as the Trump administration continues to scrutinize the university from all fronts, recently opening an investigation into its financial aid practices for foreign students and suing the school over alleged racial bias in its admissions policies.

As was the case with the antisemitism lawsuit, though, some of the White House’s other efforts crumbled in court. Last year, federal court judges ruled the Trump administration could not freeze nearly \$3 billion in research funding or bar international students from entering the country to specifically study or work at Harvard.

Both of those rulings came from lawsuits filed by the university, in response to actions from the Trump administration. But in bringing its own

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## Conn. outcome could hold significance for Markey, Moulton

House incumbent beaten by much younger challenger

By Sam Brodey  
GLOBE STAFF

It’s a New England primary fight that may sound familiar: a youngish, ambitious Democrat takes on an entrenched liberal lion with decades of service in Congress, arguing it’s time for a new generation of leadership for this fraught political moment.

On Tuesday night, that argument resounded loudly with voters — in Connecticut, where former Hartford mayor Luke Bronin defeated Representative John Larson by 22 points in a House district Larson has represented since 1999.

Speaking to supporters, Bronin called the blowout result a “political earthquake.”

But if nothing else, it is also a potentially foreboding sign for Senator Ed Markey’s chances of winning another term.

Like Representative Seth Moulton, Bronin is 47, served in the military, and positions himself as a mainstream, but not too far left, progressive. And as Moulton has done against Markey, Bronin argued the incumbent was a good representative who has simply stayed in Washington too long, re-

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Players are now required to use noise-reducing foam or 3-D-printed polymer balls, which cost more and act differently, they say.

## TAKING THE POP OUT OF PICKLEBALL

A neighbor’s had enough of the noise and Mashpee’s taking action. Players aren’t happy.

By Bryan Hecht  
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

MASHPEE — For years in this quiet coastal town, the thwacking sound of pickleball has caused an uproar.

This summer, a nearby neighbor who had long complained about the ping-pong noise celebrated a long-awaited victory — a new rule requiring muted balls.

But devotees of the divisive sport aren’t taking it quietly. Since it was announced last month, more than 600 people have signed a petition calling on the town manager to rescind the rule, which they say will devastate the local pickleball community.

“If people have to conform to this, no one will play there,” said Jill Alpert, a Mashpee resident and ambassador for USA Pickleball on Cape Cod. “I tru-

‘11.5 hours of this, constant. I wake up in the middle of the night hearing pickleball.’

EARNIE BARROWS, who lives near the pickleball park

ly believe this is the underlying hope and wish.”

As of Thursday, players at the town’s public pickleball courts must switch from classic plastic pickleballs to noise-reducing foam or 3-D-printed polymer options, in some cases costing as much as \$50 a ball.

Town Manager Rodney Collins, who implemented the rule, is standing by his decision, although he said it’s brought him more criticism than he’s ever experienced in more than two decades as a public official.

“We’ve got to control the noise,” he said. “The world isn’t going to end and the sky isn’t going to fall if they don’t play pickleball.”

By this point, pickleball feuds are standard suburban fare, but the one in Mashpee has been par-

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## Clancy conspiracy theorists dig for other truths online

By Lea Skene and Emily Spatz  
GLOBE STAFF AND GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

*This story may contain content readers find disturbing or triggering.*

Lindsay Clancy has admitted she killed her three young children. But the internet doesn’t want to believe her.

With the case drawing national and international attention, thousands have been glued to a daily livestream from the courtroom. Others are watching clips of trial testimony posted on social media. Along the way, some have latched onto a baseless conspiracy theory: that Clancy was framed, and her ex-husband is the real killer.

Online, amateur detectives can feel like a staple of the modern courtroom drama. But this particular case doesn’t

fit neatly into your typical true crime narrative because the facts aren’t really in dispute. Instead, the proceedings are focused on serious questions around mental illness, psychiatric care, and the legal complexities of asserting an insanity defense.

►Clancy allegedly searched for information on hallucinations. B1.

That hasn’t stopped the armchair investigators.

Charged with three counts of first-degree murder, Clancy has pleaded not guilty by reason of insanity, arguing her postpartum mental health conditions were exacerbated by the cocktail of psychiatric medications she was prescribed in the months after giving

CLANCY, Page A7

The family of an Acton teen accused of murdering his mother and younger brother had been hiding knives from him because of “concerning internet activities.” B1.

Peabody is the hottest housing market in the country, according to Realtor.com. B5.

The Kennedy Center board voted to inscribe President Trump’s name elsewhere on the building. A5.

The number of people who drink alcohol in a way that crosses the line into a disorder decreased substantially over a five-year period in the US. A2.

The Red Sox snapped their five-game losing streak, stopping the Blue Jays, 7-0, behind Payton Tolle’s pitching and Caleb Durbin’s grand slam. C1.



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

### Two good to be true

Friday: Sunny, less humid. High 81-86. Low 62-67.

Saturday: Just as nice. High 76-81. Low 62-67.

High tide: 12:36 a.m., 1:10 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:50 a.m. Sunset: 7:47 p.m.

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